

marketplace where I had gone with SSG Kohunski last time I went on a patrol. This time, however, the busy streets were silent and the many people I had seen were nowhere. I guess that the curfew was working. Sergeant Mayo began asking me administrative questions such as when we would get new supplies etc. He figured that I would know the answer since I worked in the operations center, and I did. I gladly gave the all the information I had—which was still speculative since nothing is ever definite in Iraq, the land of almost. Suddenly, the lead HMMWV pulled a U-turn and screeched off back in the direction we had just come. The radio sprung to life and as Horse 3 announced, "I just saw some people walking over here." Our vehicle spun around as well and we gave chase. It turned out to be nothing except two US patrols. We turned around again and resumed out patrol.

Making several turns off of the main roads, we began cruising some of the smaller streets and through various neighborhoods. It was interesting to see some of the neighborhood areas of the city. After traveling along several of the back streets we finally came to one of the main highways when the lead HMMWV again took off, this time chasing a truck. By now it was around 3 a.m. and curfew had been in effect for four hours. The HMMWV attempted to stop the truck, but the Iraqis honked at the scout vehicle and kept going. We immediately picked up speed and assisted in the chase. The scouts quickly blocked the trucks path with the HMMWV and brought it to a stop. Two of the scouts in the lead vehicle hopped out and quickly approached the truck. SSG Mayo also jumped out and covered the back side of the truck. I also got out and assumed a defensive position, covering the scouts, who by now had opened the driver's door. SSG Mayo pulled out a middle-aged man from the cab. The Iraqi man was somewhat out of shape and he fell quite a distance from his seat to the pavement. He immediately reached for his wrist. We quickly had both the Iraqi driver and passenger under guard while one of our scouts searched the truck. It turns out that they did not have any illegal weapons and appeared to be on the way to the market, probably to get a head start on the day ahead. The only casualty was the Iraqi driver who had obviously hurt his wrist when he was tossed from the truck. Oh well.

The rest of the night was uneventful and I was dropped back off here at our TOC around 5:15. Needless to say I was very tired the next day.

Take care and I love you very much.

Love,

A handwritten signature in cursive script, appearing to read "Christian".

Christian